Teacher Wu Kuan | Exam at a Glance #20 — Two Dice: Is a Sum of 7 Really 1/11?

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1. The trap question

Two dice: P(sum = 7) = 1/11?

2. The method

• The 11 possible sums are NOT equally likely.
• Use the 6 × 6 grid: 36 equally likely outcomes.
• Sum 7 occupies a full diagonal: 6 cells → 6/36 = 1/6.

3. Parent check method

Have your child fill in the 6 × 6 sum table once — after that these questions become counting.

Practice

1. P(sum is 8)
2. P(sum is 2)
3. P(sum is at least 10)
4. P(both dice show the same number)
5. P(sum is 7 or 11)

Answers

1. 5/36
2. 1/36
3. 6/36 = 1/6 (3 + 2 + 1 cells)
4. 6/36 = 1/6
5. 8/36 = 2/9

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